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Graduate Recruitment Team

Millennium Capital Management (UK) LLP

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Analyst – Trading (Global Fixed Income, Currency and Commodities team) role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Millennium's commitment to commodities, where natural gas trading drove much of its gains in 2023 and 2024, matches the market I know best.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. My lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 came from respecting variance and sizing risk to a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and as Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

Millennium stands out to me because its platform gives individual teams real responsibility for risk, and its commitment to commodities runs deep, from the natural gas trading behind much of its commodities profit in 2023 and 2024 to its \$1.5 billion backing of the Echion Capital commodities spin-out. A graduate role that mixes trading, research and software development across fixed income, currency and commodity markets suits someone whose dissertation is on TTF gas and whose work runs on code.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan